



TrustMRR Startup Database: Exploratory Analysis

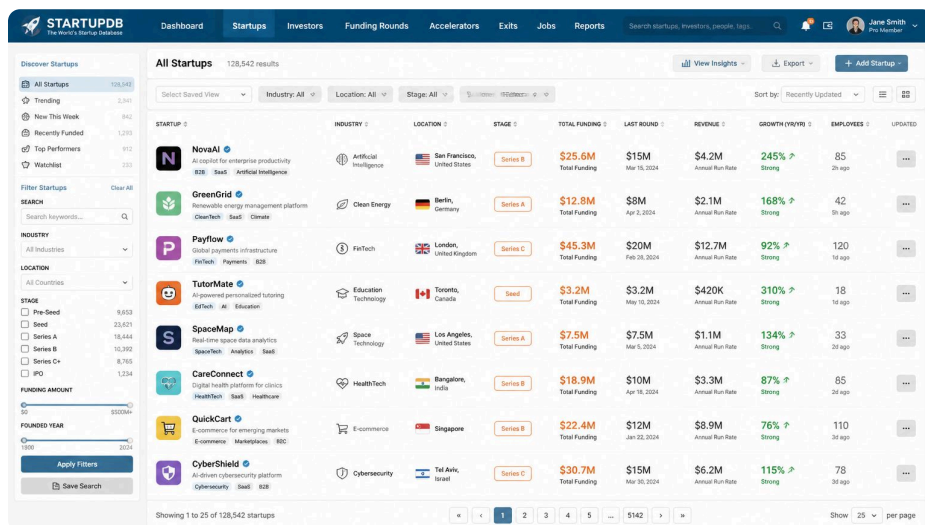
Analysis of ~700 self-reported indie & bootstrapped startups (founders list revenue, MRR, growth, subscribers, and asking price). Concise, data-forward insights for investors, analysts, and founders.

What is TrustMRR?

TrustMRR is a public, self-reported registry where indie founders list business metrics and (often) asking prices. The dataset used here contains ~700 entries with fields including:

- Monthly Recurring Revenue (MRR) / reported revenue
- Growth % (monthly or annual when provided)
- Subscriber / user counts
- Payment processor and geography
- Asking price or sale intent

Population skews toward solo founders and small teams — high signal for bootstrapped marketplace dynamics.



The screenshot shows the STARTUPDB website interface. The top navigation bar includes links for Dashboard, Startups, Investors, Funding Rounds, Accelerators, Exits, Jobs, and Reports. A search bar is located on the right. The left sidebar contains filters for Discover Startups, All Startups, Trending, New This Week, Recently Funded, Top Performers, and Watchlist. The main content area displays a table of startups with columns for Startup, Industry, Location, Stage, Total Funding, Last Round, Revenue, Growth (YTD), Employees, and Updated. The table lists several startups including NovaAI, GreenGrid, Payflow, TutorMate, SpaceMap, CareConnect, QuickCart, and CyberShield. The bottom of the page shows pagination information: Showing 1 to 25 of 128,542 startups.

STARTUP	INDUSTRY	LOCATION	STAGE	TOTAL FUNDING	LAST ROUND	REVENUE	GROWTH (YTD)	EMPLOYEES	UPDATED
NovaAI AI copilot for enterprise productivity B2B SaaS Artificial Intelligence	Artificial Intelligence	San Francisco, United States	Series B	\$25.6M Total Funding	\$15M Mar 16, 2024	\$4.2M Annual Run Rate	245% ↑ Strong	85 2h ago	...
GreenGrid Renewable energy management platform CleanTech SaaS Climate	Clean Energy	Berlin, Germany	Series A	\$12.9M Total Funding	\$9M Apr 1, 2024	\$2.1M Annual Run Rate	168% ↑ Strong	42 8h ago	...
Payflow Global payments infrastructure FinTech Payments B2B	FinTech	London, United Kingdom	Series C	\$45.3M Total Funding	\$20M Feb 28, 2024	\$12.7M Annual Run Rate	92% ↑ Strong	120 1d ago	...
TutorMate AI-powered personalized tutoring EdTech AI Education	Education Technology	Toronto, Canada	Seed	\$3.2M Total Funding	\$3.2M May 10, 2024	\$420K Annual Run Rate	310% ↑ Strong	18 1d ago	...
SpaceMap Real-time space data analytics SpaceTech Analytics SaaS	Space Technology	Los Angeles, United States	Series A	\$7.5M Total Funding	\$7.5M Mar 1, 2024	\$1.1M Annual Run Rate	134% ↑ Strong	33 2d ago	...
CareConnect Digital health platform for clinics HealthTech SaaS Healthcare	HealthTech	Bangalore, India	Series B	\$18.9M Total Funding	\$10M Apr 18, 2024	\$3.3M Annual Run Rate	87% ↑ Strong	65 3d ago	...
QuickCart E-commerce for emerging markets E-commerce Marketplaces B2C	E-commerce	Singapore	Series B	\$22.4M Total Funding	\$12M Jan 22, 2024	\$8.9M Annual Run Rate	76% ↑ Strong	110 3d ago	...
CyberShield AI-driven cybersecurity platform Cybersecurity SaaS B2B	Cybersecurity	Tel Aviv, Israel	Series C	\$30.7M Total Funding	\$15M Mar 30, 2024	\$6.2M Annual Run Rate	115% ↑ Strong	78 3d ago	...

Dataset Snapshot

Entries

~700 self-reported startups (global)

Dominant Metrics

MRR, growth %, subscribers, asking price

Founder Profile

Predominantly solo or small-team indie operators

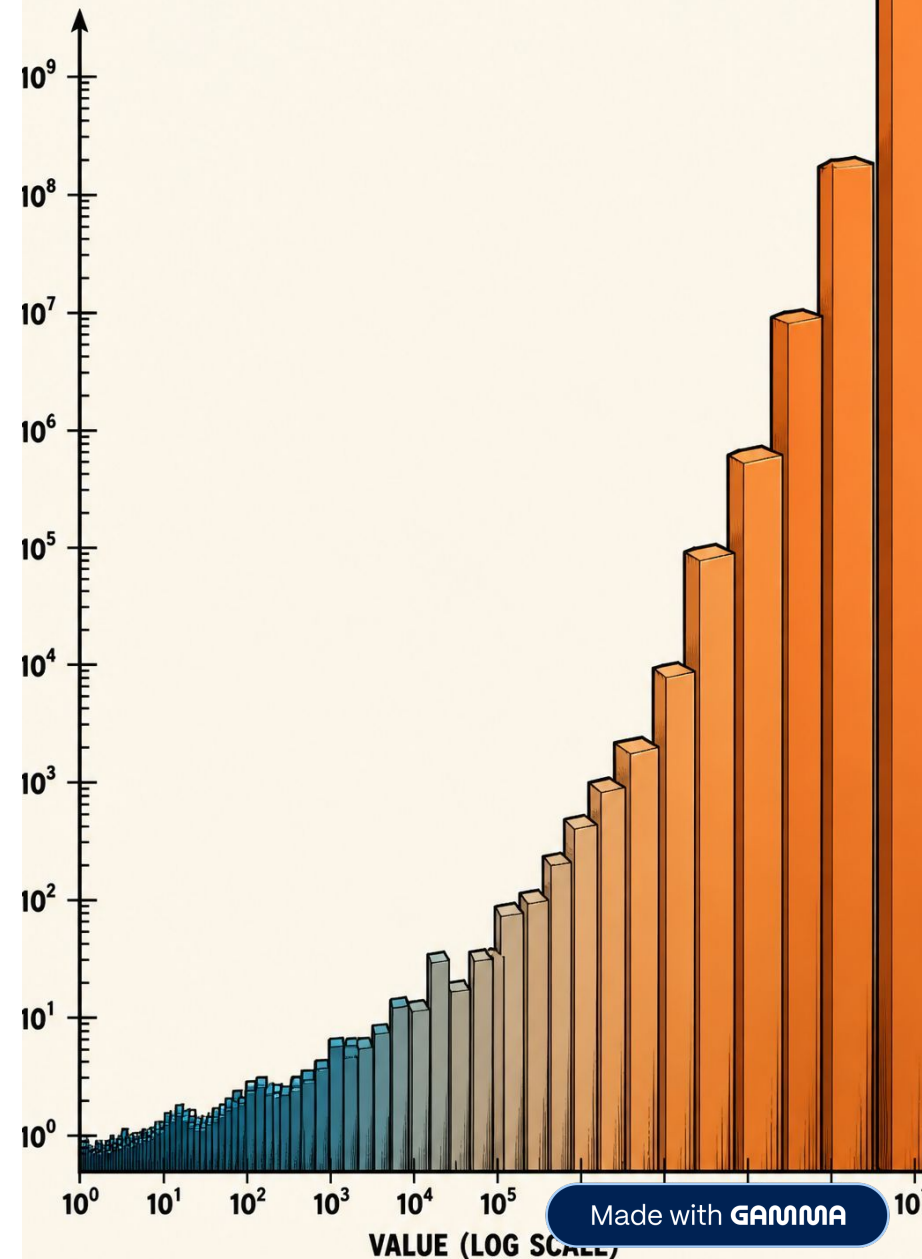
Data Quality

Self-reported — contains zeros, ranges, and optimistic estimates

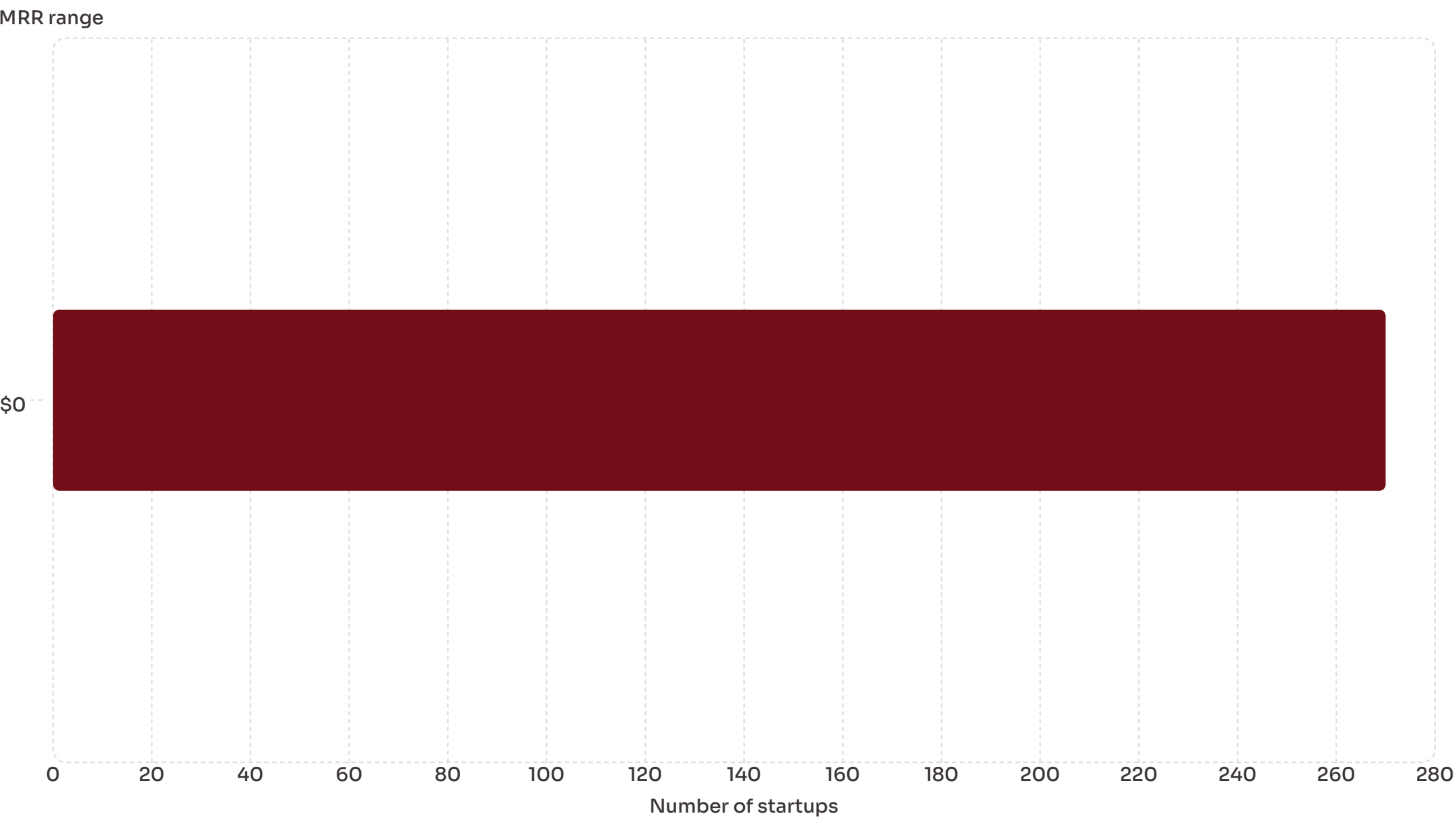
The Long Tail of Revenue

Revenue is strongly power-law distributed. A handful of outliers (examples: Stan $\approx$ \$2.8M/mo, Comp AI $\approx$ \$575K/30 days, Postiz $\approx$ \$177K/mo, Brand On Demand/Supliful $\approx$ \$51M all-time) sit far above a long tail of listings reporting \$0–a few hundred dollars/month. Many rows show 0 MRR or early-stage experiments.

- ❏ Implication: median metrics understate the economic impact of top outliers — treat mean and median separately and inspect tails.

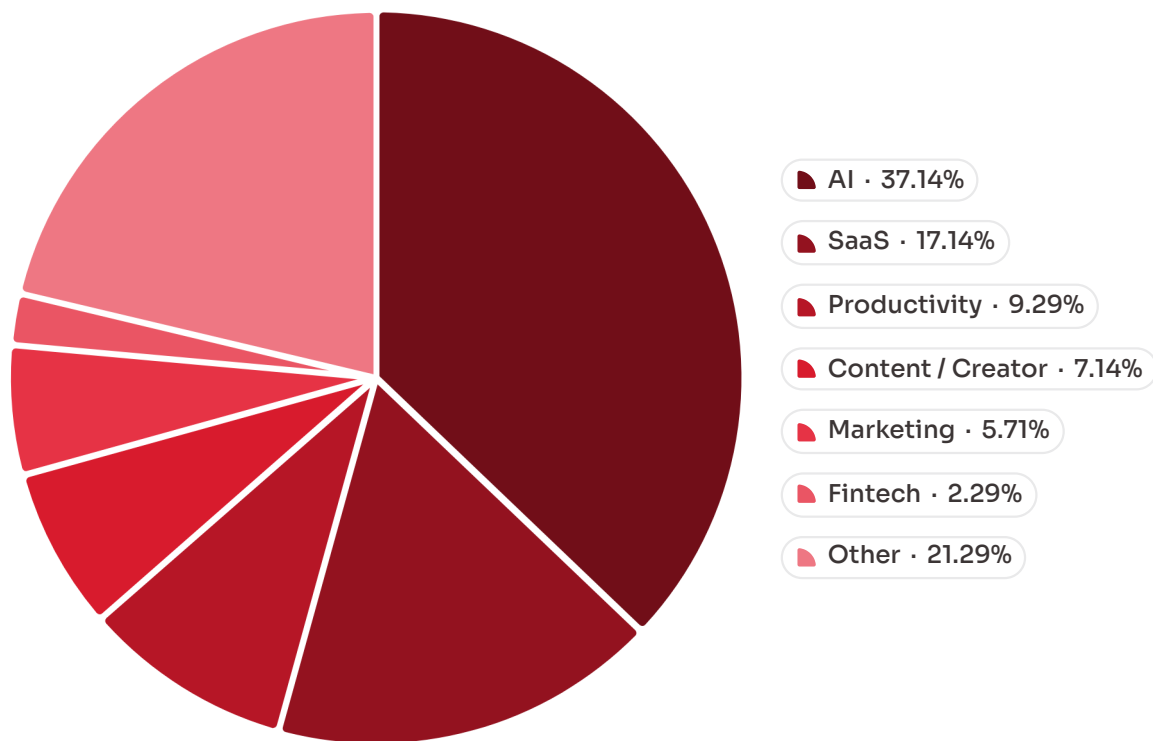


Revenue Distribution (Histogram)



Most listings cluster at or near zero MRR; a small number scale into meaningful revenue bands. Use log-scale analysis for modeling valuation or growth dynamics.

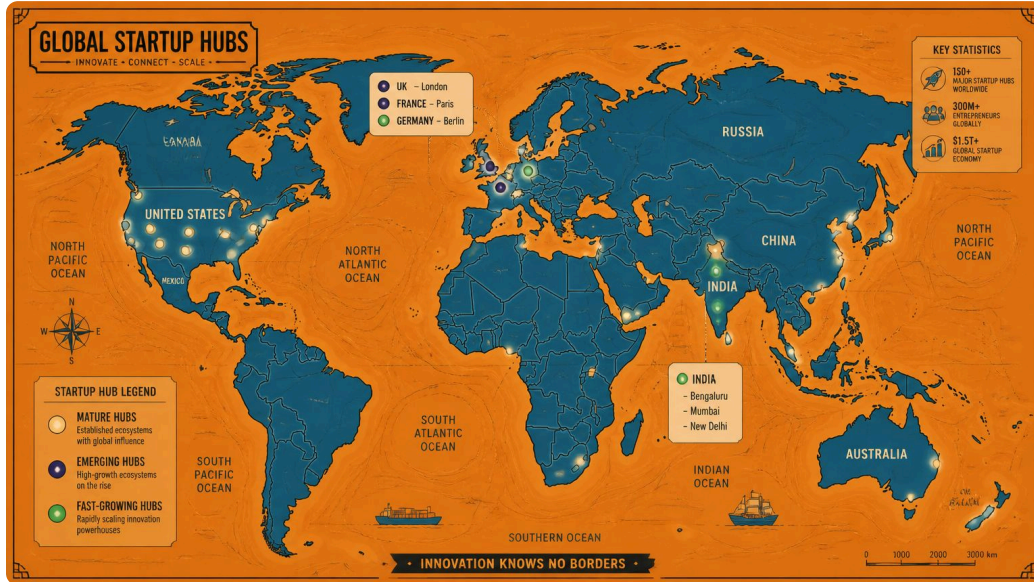
Category Breakdown



Categories reflect the 2024–2026 AI-tool boom: AI is the dominant tag (~37%). Fintech is small (16 companies) with a low median MRR (~\$500) and many zeros, indicating even traditionally high-value verticals are early-stage in this dataset.

Signal: category tag frequency $\neq$ maturity. AI tag proliferation includes many narrow utilities and experimental tools.

Geography & Payment Infrastructure



Geography: US-dominant but truly global — notable clusters in India, France, UK, and Germany plus many smaller countries. Distribution highlights global indie-hacker activity.

stripe

Stripe

Default processor for most web-based SaaS listings.



RevenueCat

Mostly mobile subscription apps.



Niche Processors

Lemon Squeezy, Paddle, Whop, Dodo Payments — indicators of scrappy, indie-hacker models.



The "For Sale" Market

Many founders list an asking price and revenue multiple. Observed patterns:

- Typical indie SaaS multiples: ~1x–5x annual revenue for pragmatic listings
- Occasional extreme asks: 100x+ — often pricing on potential rather than trailing metrics
- Zero or 0x asks: fire sales, strategic transfers, or symbolic listings

❏ Valuation divergence reflects heterogeneous goals — hobby sellers, growth-seekers, and speculators coexist in the market.

Synthesis — What the Data Says



Large Winner Effect

A tiny subset drives most dollar value; mean $\neq$ median. Expect high variance when modeling ARR or exit pools.



Category Noise

AI tag dominance reflects hype and tooling proliferation; many listings are narrow utilities.



Global, Indie-Focused

Geographically diverse with payment stack signals that identify product form factor (web, mobile, micro-SaaS).



Valuation Disconnect

Asking prices often reflect narratives or optionality, not only trailing revenue.

Key Takeaways & Next Steps

Key Takeaways

1. Power-law revenue: plan models around heavy-tail behavior.
2. AI category surge — high volume, mixed quality.
3. Payment processors act as a proxy for product type and maturity.
4. For-sale listings show valuation noise; multiples vary by seller motivation.

Recommended Next Steps

- Deep-dive top percentile (~5–10%) to characterize breakout features and channels.
- Segment buyers vs. sellers to quantify intent and closing velocity.
- Enrich with verified revenue or payment-linked data to reduce noise from zeros/estimates.

❏ If desired: prepare granular models (cohort, survival, and valuation sensitivity) using a vetted subset of 50–100 verified entries.